

SIGHT READING #1 - RHYTHMS

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #124

Reading music isn't imperative for every musician, but 99% of great jazz players read, and a majority of those are at least pretty decent sight readers. There are a few tricks of the trade that can make sight reading much easier and much less frustrating

GENERAL TIPS

- 1) Prioritize rhythms first. Pitches second, articulations third, then style and dynamics.
- 2) If you practice you'll get better. If this is a goal for you, work on it a bit each day.
- 3) The rhythms you'll see are not infinite. Nowhere close. Learn to identify the 20 or so basic rhythms you'll run across, and go from there. It's just "pattern recognition."
- 4) Look Ahead!

SPECIFIC TIPS

- 1) Determine the underlying framework of the song. 1/4 notes? 8ths? 16th note funk?
- 2) Subdivide down to the values in that framework. 8ths or 16ths typically.
- 3) Look for repetition in the rhythms. You'll almost certainly find recurring sections.
- 4) Be able to find beat one and beat 3 in every measure (when you are in 4/4).
- 5) Mark each beat (follow the bouncing ball) with your eye. Maybe use a pencil.

#1 - 1/4 Note Based Reading



#2 - 8th Note Based Reading



#3 - 16th Note Based Reading

